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Digital Tools

Technology For Personal and SoHo Productivity

Aparna Krishnakumar

Armed with easel and paintbrush, canvas and oil paint, a Web site, a CD-ROM, an Apple G4, a 22-inch LCD Cinema Display, and more than a fair share of common sense, Jaideep Mehrotra is quietly conquering new worlds.

Mehrotra on the art scene is just like the view from his elegantly comfortable home on the Mumbai seafront—calm,

is as important as any other contemporary major artist.

He is also a pioneer—he was the first artist in India to set up his own Web site, and later, the first to create and market a CD-ROM of his work.

It is not an exercise in vanity; in fact, it is a productivity tool few can afford to miss.

It has been a long time since Mehrotra set up his Web site, and began marketing his CD-ROM. Three years, in fact. And his tech-

nology training has taken the same route as his art education—everything he does is self-taught. Whether it is creating art installations, wood art or even fabric art, Mehrotra has never had any formal training.

First Among Equals

It was not a Eureka moment that brought about the idea of a CD to showcase his art, and expand his audience manifold. Mehrotra has been drawn towards technology

Jumpstart

A Brush With Technology

Jaideep Mehrotra is India's first artist to use a CD-ROM and the Web effectively to promote his work. Here's how he has harnessed technology to take his art across the globe

serene, and almost noiseless. Which is why, although he is one of India's most accomplished painters and sculptors, his name is hardly taken in the same breath as his other media-savvy colleagues. It is a pity, really, because Mehrotra's work

for quite some time now—he was VSNL's 35th customer for an Internet account at a time when it cost in excess of Rs 10,000 for a 100-hour registration. Prior to that, he was also part of the LiveWire Bulletin Board Service run by the Nanda brothers—Suchit and Anish—India's pioneering digital entrepreneurs, whose foray into BBS was viewed with much scepticism in 1992.

It would take three days for a message to reach the US, and another three for a reply if it was posted. "It was



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